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ARTICLE

At America's Party Schools, Students Are Still Running To Jesus

BY PNW STAFF APRIL 04, 2026

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Something deeply unexpected is happening on America's college campuses.

At the very places many assume are too distracted, too cynical, too secular, or too intoxicated with self to seek God, students are showing up by the thousands to worship Jesus Christ. Not in theory. Not as a social trend. Not as a political statement. But with tears, surrender, repentance, and public declarations of faith.

And perhaps nowhere is that contrast more striking than at Florida State University -- often described as one of America's top party campuses. This week, that reputation collided head-on with something far more powerful: a move of God.

According to UniteUS founder Tonya Prewett, 4,500 students gathered Tuesday night at FSU for worship, preaching, and a public call to follow Christ. She reported that hundreds made decisions for Jesus, and 81 were baptized that same night. Just as remarkable, this was not a one-time emotional spike. It was the second major spiritual eruption at FSU after thousands gathered in 2024 and hundreds were baptized in a campus fountain -- and now some of those students are returning as leaders.

That matters.

From R500 to R350,000

Lula Lona

Because one of the strongest signs that revival is real is not merely a packed altar. It is lasting fruit.

And that fruit is begin

Just last week, thousa of worship, prayer, and gospel preaching. According to reports, hundreds responded to the invitation to surrender their lives to Christ.

Baptisms went late into the night -- not in a polished church sanctuary, but in the backs of pickup trucks in a parking lot. The ministry also shared testimonies of physical healings and spiritual breakthroughs, including a moving story of a security worker who encountered prayer, gave her life to Christ, and was later baptized herself.

That is not normal campus programming.

That is hunger.

And that hunger is perhaps the most important part of this story.

For years, many Americans have been told that college students are spiritually apathetic, morally untethered, and too progressive or too online to care about faith in any serious way. But what if that reading of this generation has been badly incomplete?

What if beneath the activism, anxiety, performance, and digital noise, there is a generation exhausted by the emptiness of modern life?

Because if we are honest, today's college students have inherited a world full of confusion and contradiction. They have been told to build an identity from scratch, curate a brand, chase experiences, redefine truth, and somehow emerge whole from a culture that offers constant stimulation but very little peace. They have access to more information than any generation in history -- and yet many seem starved for meaning.

That is why these scenes are so compelling.

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Students are not merely attending an event. They are responding to a Person.

And increasingly, they are doing it in places that symbolize the very spiritual drift so many Christians have lamented.

That is why the reviva [illegible] place of repentance and baptism, then ma [illegible] wrote off are becoming mission fields where the Holy Spirit is doing His most surprising work.

And FSU is not alone.

Earlier this year at the University of Central Florida, more than 5,000 students gathered for a UniteUS event where Prewett reported 1,600 students made decisions to "go all in with Jesus." Hundreds were baptized, and the ministry said many who had identified as atheists left identifying as Christians.

This is part of a much larger pattern.

Since launching at Auburn University in September 2023, UniteUS has grown into one of the most visible evangelistic movements on American campuses. The ministry says more than 100,000 students have participated in its outreaches, and by some later counts, that number has climbed beyond 120,000 as the gatherings have spread to schools including Alabama, Georgia, Cincinnati, Tennessee, Oklahoma, Purdue, Clemson, NC State, Grand Canyon, South Florida, and beyond. Upcoming events are also planned at Samford University and Oklahoma State University in the coming weeks.

And while UniteUS is not the only expression of what is happening, it is clearly one of the strongest signs that the post-2023 Asbury revival spiritual momentum has not vanished. What began for many Christians as a hopeful spark at Asbury has not simply faded into nostalgia. In many places, it appears to be spreading outward into public universities, secular spaces, and unexpected corners of youth culture.

Christians should rejoice in that.

But we should also be careful.

Real revival is not measured only by crowd size, emotional moments, or viral clips on Instagram. Revival becomes meaningful when it leads to discipleship, holiness, biblical grounding, church connection, repentance, and endurance. A raised hand is beautiful. A transformed life is even more beautiful.

That is why the most encouraging detail from FSU may not be the number 4,500. It may be the testimony that students who encountered Jesus in 2024 returned in 2026 not just as attendees -- but as leaders.

That is how awakening matures.

Not when a campus has one unforgettable night, but when students begin carrying the fire into dorm rooms, friend groups, Bible studies, local churches, and ordinary Tuesday afternoons long after the music stops.

And perhaps that is exactly why so many college students are responding right now.

They are not just looking for inspiration.

They are looking for something real.

Something holy.

Something stronger than alcohol, hookup culture, ambition, depression, politics, and self-invention.

They are looking for t

And the stunning news is that many of them appear to be finding Him.

For a nation that has spent years sounding the alarm over the spiritual direction of the next generation, this should not merely be observed. It should be prayed over. Encouraged. Protected. And celebrated.

Because if Jesus Christ is still being exalted on America's campuses -- even at its party schools -- then the story is not over.

It may just be beginning.

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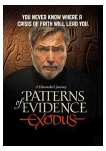

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